Dharani Nadendla

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Research Interests

Consistency in multi-agent large language model (LLM) systems: formally defining consistency across interacting agents, identifying root causes of inconsistency, and developing metrics and benchmarks. Broader interests: trustworthy AI, knowledge-infused learning.

Education

University of Maryland, Baltimore County — August 2026 - present
Ph.D. in Computer Science — Baltimore, MD, USA

University of Maryland, Baltimore County — January 2025 - August 2026
M.P.S. in Data Science — Baltimore, MD, USA

Vellore Institute of Technology — July 2020 - May 2024
B.Tech in Computer Science — Andhra Pradesh, India

Employment

Graduate Teaching Assistant — August 2026 - present
University of Maryland, Baltimore County — Baltimore, MD, USA

Student Affairs Senator — July 2026 - present
Graduate Student Association, UMBC — Baltimore, MD, USA

Graduate Research Assistant — January 2026 - August 2026
University of Maryland, Baltimore County — Baltimore, MD, USA

Mathematics Tutor — August 2025 - December 2025
University of Maryland, Baltimore County — Baltimore, MD, USA

Publications

[1] Renzhi Hao, Shirui Cao, Yizhu Wen, Rishav Gupta, **Dharani Nadendla**, Mehran Kafai, Hanqing Guo, and Dong Li. "Ultrasound Watermark: Real-Time Acoustic Watermarking against Voice Scams on Smartphones." *ACM MobiCom 2027*. (Under review)

[2] Yizhu Wen*, **Dharani Nadendla***, Shirui Cao, Renzhi Hao, Dong Li, and Hanqing Guo. "EchoGuard: Continuous Ultrasound-Based Human Presence Verification for AI Agent Detections." *In Proceedings of the 9th ACM/IEEE Workshop on Security and Privacy in Edge Computing (EdgeSP2026)*, August 2026. (Accepted)

[3] Renzhi Hao, Shirui Cao, Yizhu Wen, Rishav Gupta, **Dharani Nadendla**, Mehran Kafai, Hanqing Guo, and Dong Li. "Ultrasound Watermark: Real-Time Acoustic Watermarking against Voice Scams

on Smartphones." *In Proceedings of the 9th ACM/IEEE Workshop on Security and Privacy in Edge Computing (EdgeSP2026)*, August 2026. (Accepted)

[4] Bojing Li, Duo Zhong, **Dharani Nadendla**, Gabriel Terceros, Prajna Bhandary, Raguvir S, and Charles Nicholas. "MASCOT: Analyzing Malware Evolution Through a Well-Curated Source Code Dataset." *arXiv preprint* arXiv:2512.00741, November 2025.

*Equal contribution.

AWARDS

COEIT Best Poster Award April 2026
UMBC Annual Research Symposium Baltimore, MD, USA

SERVICE

Student Volunteer December 2025
ACM/IEEE Symposium on Edge Computing Washington, D.C., USA

SKILLS

Programming: Python, MATLAB, Kotlin, Java, linux, Haskell, latex
Methods: machine learning, signal processing, wireless and acoustic sensing, malware analysis, Adversarial methods
Tools: Android studio, Audition